

SENATE BILL 873

By Reeves

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 9; Title 39, Chapter 17, Part 13 and Title 49, relative to school safety grants. This act makes appropriations for school safety grants for the fiscal years beginning July 1, 2024, and July 1, 2025.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. In addition to any funds appropriated by the provisions of this act, there is appropriated the sum of \$20,000,000 (nonrecurring) to the Department of Education, for the sole purpose of providing school safety grants to LEAs and public charter schools to be used to provide walk-through detectors and scanners in schools; provided, that if a school already has walk-through detectors and scanners installed, then the grants may be used for other prevention, reduction, and response efforts toward school shootings. It is the legislative intent that such funds be appropriated for the same purpose in this section in fiscal years 2026-2027 and 2027-2028.

SECTION 2. In addition to any funds appropriated by the provisions of this act, there is appropriated the sum of \$4,000,000 (nonrecurring) to the Department of Education, for the sole purpose of providing school safety grants to non-public schools in the same manner as funds appropriated in Section 54, Item 1, line item 41 of Chapter 418 of the Public Acts of 2023 to be used to provide walk-through detectors and scanners in schools; provided, that if a school already has walk-through detectors and scanners installed, then the grants may be used for other prevention, reduction, and response efforts toward school shootings.

SECTION 3. This act takes effect July 1, 2025, the public welfare requiring it.